

KEEPING IT REAL

PENDING HOME SALES FELL ALMOST EVERYWHERE. NOT HERE.

NAR's July numbers, region by region. One region moved the opposite direction.

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**THE MIDWEST WAS
THE ONLY REGION
WHERE PENDING
HOME SALES ROSE
YEAR OVER YEAR
IN JULY.**

NAR's Pending Home Sales Index, released August 2026.

THE NATIONAL HEADLINE AND YOUR LOCAL MARKET ARE NOT THE SAME STORY.

NAR's July 2026 Pending Home Sales Index fell 2.3% month over month nationally and 2.2% year over year, a pullback NAR chief economist Lawrence Yun tied to "the highest mortgage rates of the year" hitting mid-summer. The West dropped 4.7% for the month and 7.1% for the year, the steepest of any region. The Midwest fell just 0.7% for the month, the smallest regional decline, and was the only region up year over year, at 1.7%.

WHAT TO DO WITH THAT BEFORE YOUR NEXT APPOINTMENT:

1 Pull the regional number, not the national one.

NAR breaks pending sales out by region every month. Know your region's figure before a seller brings up a headline.

2 When a seller cites a scary national number, show them the regional one.

The story two states over is not automatically the story on your block.

3 Tell buyers the truth about where they're standing.

Midwest buyers kept signing contracts in July while three other regions pulled back. That's a fact worth saying, not a sales pitch.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE MARKET DIDN'T COOL EVERYWHERE IN JULY.

Know which story your region is actually telling.